STATE OF CALIFORNIA
Franchise Tax Board

2019
VITA/TCE
California Volunteer Reference Manual

California Volunteers Make the Difference

The links throughout this manual will not be updated on the website prior to December 15th.

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Critical Numbers

Site Information: Site Name:_____
Site ID Number (SIDN):_____
Partner Information: Name:_____
Phone Number:_____
State Coordinator: Name: _____
Phone Number:_____

Franchise Tax Board Field offices

City	Address	Zip Code
Los Angeles	300 S. Spring St., Suite 5704	90013-1233
Oakland	1515 Clay St., Suite 305	94612-1445
Sacramento	3321 Power Inn Rd, Suite 250	95826-3893
San Diego	7575 Metropolitan Dr., Suite 201	92108-4421
Santa Ana	600 W. Santa Ana Blvd, Suite 300	92701-4532

Volunteer Hotline

(Volunteers only- not for the taxpayer)

California Franchise Tax Board (FTB)	800.522.5665
Federal Internal Revenue Services (IRS)	800.829.8482

Public Assistance

(For the taxpayers)

FTB from within the United States	800.852.5711
FTB from outside the United States	916.845.6500
FTB automated assistance	800.338.0505
For Federal (IRS) questions	800.829.1040
For TTY/TDD (persons with disabilities)	800.822.6268

Websites

California Franchise Tax Board (FTB)	ftb.ca.gov
In the search field, enter the underlined word or number:	
	VITA, Volunteer Income Tax Assistance
	Live Chat for online assistance
	2335, VITA Military Worksheet
	5135, VITA Military Reference Guide
Internal Revenue Service (IRS)	irs.gov
TaxSlayer Training System	vita.taxslayerpro.com
Link and Learn Certification	linklearncertification.com

Correspondence

If you write to us, be sure your letter includes your/clients social security number and your daytime and evening telephone numbers. Mail your letter to:

Franchise Tax Board

PO BOX 942840

SACRAMENTO, CA 94240-0040

Self-Help E-Services MyFTB

Provides tax account information and online services to Individuals, Business Representatives and tax Preparers.

As an individual, you can use MyFTB to access:

- Account information
- View account balance and tax year details
- View estimated payments and credits before filing a return
- View payment history
- View a list and images of a tax return
- View a list and images of notices and correspondence
- View and update contact information
- View proposed assessments
- View California wage and withholding information
- View FTB-issued 1099 information
- View a list of authorized representatives (tax preparer or a tax preparer with a power of attorney) and manage who can access your account
- View a list of activities that occurred on your account, such as the last time you or your authorized representative accessed your account.
- Online Services
- Calculate a balance due for a date in the future
- File a Power of Attorney (POA)
- File a nonresident withholding waiver request
- Protest a proposed assessment
- Options to communicate with us
- Chat with an FTB representative about confidential matters
- Send a secure message with attachments to FTB
- Choose to receive an email when we send you a notice or correspondence

How to access MyFTB

You will need to complete a one-time registration process to access MyFTB account. Go to My FTB Account

When you register, you must select a user name and password and provide the following information:

- A valid email address
- Your social security number
- Your first and last name from the most recently filed California tax return or the name provided via telephone or FTB 3533, Change of Address.
- Information from a CA tax return filed in the last five years:
  - Year of the tax return
  - Filing status used on the tax return

- CA adjusted gross income (AGI) on the tax return

If you have not filed a CA tax return in one of the last five years, you cannot register. If you need additional information, please contact us at 800.852.5711 (voice) or 800.822.6268 (TTY/TDD) during business hours.

For clients who owe, there is an easy way to pay:

With instant access to taxpayer, information and services available 24 hours a day, the online payment options at ftb.ca.gov will save your clients time and hassle. Plus, paying online is another way to save natural resources like trees. Encourage your clients to pay their taxes online!

- **Web Pay-** Make your personal income tax payments online. You can pay today or schedule your payment up to one year in advance. If you use Web Pay, do not mail the paper payment voucher. Web Pay for Individuals | California Franchise Tax Board
- **Credit card-** Pay with your discover/NOVUS, Master card, Visa or American Express. Make your payment online or by phone at Official Payments . Official Payments Corporation charges a convenience fee of 2.5% (minimum $1) to use this service.
- **Check or money order-** Mail your payment or pay in person at a field office.

Installment Agreement

If you cannot pay the full amount you owe and would like to make monthly payments, you must first request an Installment Agreement.

You may qualify for an installment agreement if you:

- Owe a balance of $25,000 or less
- Agree to pay your balance due in 60 months or less
- Have filed all required personal income tax returns

Approval will be based on ability to pay and compliance history. A lien may be filed and a financial statement requested as a conditional approval.

How to apply

- **Apply online-** You must agree to special requirements and have a bank account
- **By mail-** Complete FTB Form 3567 (Installment Agreement Request) and mail it to the address shown on page 1. Failure to provide complete information will delay the processing of your request. Do not attach this form to your tax return.
- **By phone-** Call us at 800.689.4776, Monday through Friday between 8 a.m. and 5 p.m., except state holidays.

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Objective

Volunteers

1. Define the scope of the VITA/TCE program
2. Understand your volunteer responsibilities
3. Understand the privacy and disclosure policy
4. Identify and locate the reference materials available

Scope of VITA/TCE

The VITA/TCE program assists individuals with limited income who need help completing simple federal and state income tax returns. Non-resident and part-year resident tax returns can be complex. This manual excludes instructions for the California long or short Form 540NR. This manual limits instructions to California resident tax returns only.

Generally, volunteer sites open as early as January 15 and provide assistance through April 15 each year. In all cases, VITA/TCE sites do not charge for assistance.

Volunteer Responsibilities

Volunteers make the program work by fulfilling these responsibilities:

- Complete the Federal training and certify on Link and Learn
- Attend and complete the State tax training
- Be available January thru April 15th to provide assistance
- Use the IRS and FTB manuals and the reference guides to help you provide accurate information to your clients
- Call the IRS or FTB volunteer hotlines for answers to Federal and State tax questions

You do not have a legal responsibility for the tax returns you prepare. Let your clients know that the tax returns legal responsibility is theirs. The Volunteer Protection Act of 1997, PL 105-19 exempts a volunteer of a nonprofit organization or governmental entity from liability for harm caused by an act of omission by the volunteer on behalf of such organization or entity.

Privacy and Disclosure of Information

Your clients provide confidential information with their tax returns and financial information. You are not to disclose and/or discuss this information under any circumstance with anyone other than the client and authorized individuals. You must take actions to erase confidential information on the computer's hard drive. Volunteers are subject to the criminal penalty provisions of 18 U.S.C Section 1905 for any improper disclosures of customer information.

It is critical to the VITA/TCE Program's success to ensure volunteers safeguard customer information and understand their responsibility to protect confidential information under a need to know basis. Arrange your assistance area to enhance the privacy of your clients. Prevent others from overhearing or seeing the information.

You must sign IRS Form 13615, *Volunteers Standard of Conduct Agreement*. This agreement and its provisions apply to the state returns you prepare.

As a volunteer, all information you receive from the taxpayer is strictly confidential and should not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals.

Site Number/SIDN

The IRS assigns every volunteer site a site number (SIDN). This number will be added automatically from the default software setup on all tax returns for identification purposes.

No Acceptance of Payments

The VITA/TCE Program provides free assistance. You may not accept payment of any form under any circumstance, either for your services or on behalf of the IRS or FTB.

Client Documents

It is essential for the site appointment maker to tell, e-mail, and/or printout the needed documents list of all tax related items the client needs to bring to their appointment. All necessary records are needed to complete an accurate tax return.

To complete an accurate tax return the client needs to bring:

1. A completed IRS Intake/Interview quality review sheet
   - IRS Form 13614-C, Intake/Interview and Quality Review sheet
   - Answer the questions about the client and their family
   - Birthdates for the taxpayer, spouse and dependents
   - Health insurance coverage for all members, IRS Form 1095-A,1095-B and 1095-C
2. Copy of last year's Federal and State tax returns
   - Gives you some idea of the tax return's complexity
   - Shows the forms used in the prior year return
   - Allows you to crosscheck the client's information: Social security number(s) and dependent(s) information
3. Wage and earning statements like Forms W-2, W-2G, 1099-R and other 1099's
4. Any other relevant information about income and expenses
5. Checkbook for bank routing and account numbers for direct deposit
6. Day care receipt with the total amount paid and the day care provider's:
   - Name, Address and phone number
   - Tax Identification or Social security number
7. The following itemized items for clients who itemize:
   - Mortgage interest statement (normally on December or January bill or 1098)
   - Real Estate tax documents
   - Vehicle Registration from DMV
   - Charitable contributions with receipts or documentation to substantiate
   - For other itemized deduction information go to: irs.gov/taxtopics/tc500.html
8. Yearend Brokerage statement
9. Rental property income and expenses, for more information go to:
   - IRS Publication 527, *Residential Rental Property*

Generally, you should fully complete the taxpayer's tax return at the time of service. **Do not** retain taxpayer documents for a follow-up visit. If more data is required, give everything back to the client. The client should provide the entire package with the missing information when they return.

Replenishing Supplies

To replenish your supplies of state forms and publications, complete Form 2333V-CA and return it to the Volunteer Income Tax Assistance team. You may also call the Volunteer Hotline at 800.522.5665, to order forms or email your order to volunteercoordinator@ftb.ca.gov.

The Volunteer hotline can assist with the following:

- Tracking of orders
- Tax preparation questions
- TaxSlayer software assistance

The Volunteer Hotline hours of operation are 8am to 4pm Monday thru Friday, except state holidays. You can reach the Volunteer Hotline staff at 800.522.5665.

Change in Location and/or Service hours

If you have a change in location or service hours, do one of the following:

1. Call the Volunteer Hotline and inform them;
    - That you are a volunteer for the VITA/TCE program
    - The location of your site (Including county and Zip code)
    - The change in location and/or hours
2. Notify the organizations, media and other persons whom you previously contacted regarding location and hours of operation.
3. Correct or remove the posters distributed throughout the community. This is to notify the public of your closure or change in location and/or hours of operation.

Note: We provide links to volunteer site lists. The IRS and AARP provide the site listings, any change in service hours, location or contact numbers should be updated with the IRS as soon as possible.

Questions or Assistance outside the Scope of the Program

On matters beyond your training, refer the client to the toll-free public assistance telephone numbers: IRS 800.829.1040 or FTB 800.852.5711. It may be necessary to suggest the client hire a tax service or enrolled agent to file their complicated tax returns.

Volunteer References

In order to produce the best possible product, locate and use the following reference materials:

At ftb.ca.gov enter the form number or word into the search field

- 5130, *VITA/TCE California Volunteer Reference Manual*
- VITA/TCE home page

TaxSlayer Software

- TaxSlayer Pro
- You will need to obtain your user name from your site coordinator to sign into the live environment. If you are a new volunteer, your site coordinator will provide you with your user name and password for the live environment.
- TaxSlayer help center

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TaxSlayer Log in

The site coordinator sets up the volunteer's account in TaxSlayer using their tax center client ID. Coordinators can use TaxSlayer's online instructions or call the Volunteer Hotline for assistance on how to do this.

- When you log in to your account in TaxSlayer for the first time, the "Account Update" screen will come up.

Keep in mind the "Account Update" screen only needs to be completed once.

- Enter your correct cell phone number
- Use an email address you will be able to access each time you log in

TaxSlayer requires you to get an **authentication code** every 7 days when you log in using the same computer or every single time you log into TaxSlayer using a different computer. You may choose to receive the authentication code either via the cell number you entered on the "Account Update" screen or via email at the email address you used on the "Account Update" screen.

After you complete the "Account Update" screen, you may be asked if you want to Sync your account. **Do NOT sync.** Otherwise, the system will sync all your accounts to one login ID and you may not be able to log into different sites with different login name.

Once you have entered the appropriate information, you will be logged into TaxSlayer.

Username: _____

Password: _____

Annually TaxSlayer updates the current California state forms in late January. During California State tax training, it will be necessary for you to use the prior year TaxSlayer online program.

The information you type into TaxSlayer is crucial. Key it as you see it. Type each tax form into TaxSlayer exactly how it looks. When you put correct information into TaxSlayer, you get correct information out. Make sure to verify the documents provided from your taxpayer are for the correct tax year. Occasionally, taxpayers will provide you with prior year tax documents.

Check Social Security Numbers

It is important to check your client's tax forms to verify their social security numbers match.

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What's New for 2019 at a Glance

Use this as a quick reference guide for current Federal and State Tax Law

Federal and State Standard Deduction

2019 Filing Status	Single	Married Filing Joint	Head of Household
Federal Under 65	$12,200	$24,400	$18,350
Federal 65 and over or blind	$13,850	$25,700 (one spouse) $27,000 (both spouses)	$20,000
CA	$4,537	$9,074	$9,074
CA Personal Exemption Credits	$122	$244	$122

Federal and State Nonconformities

	Federal	State
Medical Expense Deduction	10% of AGI	7.5% above AGI
Alimony	For 2019 and after, for divorces executed or modified after December 31 2018, the individual who pays alimony to an ex-spouse will no longer be able to deduct those payments. And the recipient of the alimony is not required to pay taxes on that income	California requires the amount of alimony received to be included in the gross income of the recipient
Itemized Deductions-Charitable Contributions	If a charitable contribution is made by cash or property after August 27 2018 and the taxpayer received or is expected to receive a state or local tax credit, they must reduce the contribution deduction on Schedule A by the amount of credit they received or is expected to receive. There is an exception, if the credit is not more than 15% of the amount of contribution, the taxpayer can take the deduction. Otherwise, the deduction has to be reduced so the credit will not be more than 15% of the contribution deduction.	Allows up to 50% of AGI

Federal and State Conformities

Topics	Information
Charitable Contributions	If the credit is 15% of the contribution amount or less you can take the deduction. Otherwise, the deduction will need to be reduced
Kiddie Tax	The exemption is $2,200. A parent will be able to elect to include a child's income on their return for 2019 if the child's income is more than $1,100 and less than $11,000
In Home Support Services (IHSS)	Allows the exclusion of Medicaid Waiver payments from the gross income when the Medicaid Waiver eligible individual is living in the provider's home-Income has to be removed from CalEITC calculation for CalEITC
Student Loan	Allows the exclusion from gross income the amount of student loan indebtedness discharged on or after December 31 2018 due to the death or total and permanent disability of the student-Conforms to Federal with modifications.

New State Credit

Credit
CA offers a Young Child Tax Credit; the requirements differ from the Federal Child Tax Credit. **Young Child Tax Credit**-is an add-on (or additional credit) to taxpayers that qualify for CalEITC who have children under the age of 6. The credit amount phases out as AGI exceeds the "threshold amount" of $25,000, and completely phases out at $30,000. • Max Income-Under $30,000 • Child age must be under 6 years of age • Max Credit $1,000

Other

	Federal	State
Individual Responsibility Payment for Health Coverage/ACA	Eliminated effective 1/1/2019	CA adopted the Individual Healthcare Mandate beginning 1/1/2020. All CA residents and their dependents are required to obtain and maintain healthcare coverage throughout the year. Failure to do so could result in a penalty of up to $695 per uninsured beginning in filing season 2021

Introduction to California Tax Law

1. Understand the key terms related to California tax law
2. Determine income taxed by California.
3. Determine the taxpayer's filing requirements.
4. Determine the proper filing status.
5. Determine the correct tax forms to file.
6. Explain the automatic extension rules.
7. Define the key tax terms in the glossary of tax terms.

General Information

In this manual, we strive to include the information that most volunteers may find useful. It is not possible to include all requirements of the California Revenue and Taxation Code (R&TC) in this manual. This manual should be used as a guide and reference tool and it should not be considered as authoritative law.

Filing Date

The due date for filing the 2019 tax returns is April 15 2020. Therefore, the 2019 tax return and payments received on or before April 15 2020, are considered timely and are not subject to penalties and interest.

Automatic Extension to File

For taxpayers who miss the filing deadline of April 15 2020, CA grants paperless extensions to file their tax return by October 15 2020. This extension is to avoid late filing penalties and additional interest; however, it is not an extension to pay any amount owed. Any payment for taxes due on the return must be submitted by April 15 2020 to avoid penalties and interest.

If a client is living or traveling outside the United States on April 15 2020, the due dates for filing their return and paying the taxes owed is June 15 2020. Taxpayer will not be charged penalties for nonpayment; however, interest will still accrue from April 15th.

If the taxpayer cannot file by June 15 2020, they can also be granted an automatic six-month extension. This would make the due date for filing the return December 15 2020; however, it is not an extension to pay any amount owed.

California Residency

Residency is significant because it determines what income is taxed by California. An individual becomes a resident of California when they make California their home versus when they come here for a visit. Generally, we presume residency if an individual spends nine months or more of the calendar year in California. Refer to Publication 1031, Guidelines for Determining Residency Status for more information.

Full-year resident of California- Any individual who is present in California for other than temporary or transitory purposes or domiciled in California, but outside of California for a temporary or transitory purpose. California residents are taxed on ALL income, including sources outside of California.

Non-resident of California- Any individual who is not a resident of California. Non-residents of California are taxed ONLY on income from a California source. Nonresidents of California are not taxed on lump sum distributions from a qualified plan or annuity received after December 31 1995. However, lump-sum distributions, derived from a California source, received from most nonqualified plans after December 31 1995, continue to be taxable by California. Review FTB Publication 1005, Pensions and Annuity Guidelines, for more information.

Part-year resident of California- Any individual who is a resident of California for part of the year and a non-resident for part of the year. A Part-year resident is taxed on all income received while a resident of California and only on income from a California source when considered a Non-resident.

Temporary or Transitory-

Non-permanent or short period stays in California are considered temporary or transitory visits. Generally, your state of residence is where you have your closest connections. If you leave your state of residence, it is important to determine if your presence in a different location is for a temporary or transitory purpose. You should consider the purpose and length of your stay when determining your residency.

Coming into California

When you are present in California for temporary or transitory purposes, you are a nonresident of California. For instance, if you come to California for a vacation, TDY (Temporary Duty Assignment) and complete a transaction or you are simply passing through, your purpose is temporary or transitory. As a nonresident, you are taxed only on your income from California sources. When you are in California for other than a temporary or transitory purpose, you are a California resident. For instance, if your employer assigns you to an office in California for a long or indefinite period, if you retire and come to California with no specific plans to leave, or if you are ill and are in California for an indefinite recuperation period, your stay is other than temporary or transitory. As a resident, you are taxed on all income from all sources.

Leaving California

Any individual who is a resident of California continues to be a resident when absent from the state for a temporary or transitory purpose. Individuals absent from California under an employment-related contract for a period of at least 546 consecutive days may be considered an absence for other than temporary or transitory purposes, if all the following are met:

- Are under an employment related contract of at least 546 consecutive days
- Do not return to California for more than 45 days in a current year
- Do not receive more than $200,000 of intangible income
- Did not leave to avoid taxes

California Tax Forms

Below is a list of the personal income tax forms for California:

- 2019 540 2EZ - Used for Full year residents
- 2019 540 - Used for Full year residents
- 2019 540NR - Form for part year residents and nonresidents

Filing Status

As a rule, taxpayers must use the same filing status for their California return as on their federal return. However, there are some exceptions.

The filing status are:

- Single
- Head Of household
- Married filing joint
- Married filing separately
- Qualified Widow(er)

Same-sex married couples have a legally recognized marital union and must follow the Married Filing Joint requirements.

Married couples must file their income tax returns using one of the following filing statuses:

- Married/Registered Domestic Partner Filing Jointly
- Married/RDP Filing Separately or
- Head of Household

If clients file a joint return for federal purposes, they may file separately for California if either spouse was one of the following:

- An active member of the United States Armed Forces or any auxiliary military branch during the taxable year
- A nonresident for the entire year with no income from California sources during the taxable year

Keep in mind: If the spouse earning the California source income is domiciled in a community property state, community income will be split equally between the spouses. Both spouses will have California income based on community property rules.

General Filing Requirements

If a taxpayer is questioning whether he or she should file a tax return, you should always advise them to file to avoid penalties and additional interest, if applicable.

If a taxpayer does not have a filing requirement, he/she may want to file a tax return to claim a refund, if any, of the following are true:

- If there are California withholdings on a Form W-2 or any 1099's that the taxpayer receives
- The taxpayer paid any estimated payments to the State of California
- The taxpayer qualifies for California EITC or the young child tax credit

Filing Requirements

Generally, California resident, Part-year resident and Non-resident taxpayers are required to file a return if they meet the income thresholds in the charts below. Your client has a filing requirement if either their gross or adjusted gross income from all sources exceeds the listed amount for their filing status, age and number of dependents.

In addition, FTB provides minimum filing requirement thresholds to ensure that most people who will not owe taxes are not required to file a tax return. FTB adjusts these tables each year to include the added senior exemption and the dependent exemption credits, For example, most single people under 65 years old with no dependents would not need to file a state return until they have California adjusted gross income of $18,241 or more.

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Single or Head of household:

Under the age of 65

Gross Income

- No dependents $18,241
- One dependent $30,841
- Two or more dependents $40,291

Adjusted Gross Income

- No dependents $14,593
- One dependent $27,193
- Two or more dependents $36,643

Over the age of 65

Gross Income

- No dependents $24,341
- One dependent $33,791
- Two or more dependents $41,351

Adjusted Gross Income

- No dependents $20,693
- One dependent $30,143
- Two or more dependents $37,703

Married/RDP filing jointly (both spouses/RDPs):

Under the age of 65

Gross Income

- No dependents $36,485
- One dependent $49,085
- Two or more dependents $58,535

Adjusted Gross Income

- No dependents $29,190
- One dependent $41,790
- Two or more dependents $51,240

Over the age of 65 (One spouse/RDP)

Gross Income

- No dependents $42,585
- One dependent $52,035
- Two or more dependents $59,595

Adjusted Gross Income

- No dependents $35,290
- One dependent $44,740
- Two or more dependents $52,300

Over the age of 65 (Both spouses/RDPs)

Gross Income

- No dependents $48,685
- One dependent $58,135
- Two or more dependents $65,695

Adjusted Gross Income

- No dependents $41,390
- One dependent $50,840
- Two or more dependents $58,400

Qualifying widow(er)

Under the age of 65

Gross Income

- One dependent $30,841
- Two or more dependents $40,291

Adjusted Gross Income

- One dependent $27,193
- Two or more dependents $36,643

Over the age of 65

Gross Income

- One dependent $33,791
- Two or more dependents $41,351

Adjusted Gross Income

- One dependent $30,143
- Two or more dependents $37,703

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Additional filing thresholds

Below are additional situations when a taxpayer must file a return even if their income was below the threshold:

- Tax on a lump-sum distribution
- Tax on a qualified retirement plan including an Individual Retirement Arrangement (IRA) or Archery Medical Savings Account (MSA)
- Tax for children under age 19 or a student under age 24 who have investment income greater than $2,200
- Alternative minimum tax
- Recapture taxes
- Deferred tax on certain installment obligations
- Tax on an accumulation distribution from a trust

Dependent of another person's filing requirements

If the taxpayer is a dependent of another person, regardless of their filing status and age, they must file a tax return if their gross income from all sources is more than their standard deduction. The filing requirement is based on the standard deduction even if the taxpayer is itemizing their deductions. Use the Standard Deduction worksheet for the Dependents, which is located in the 2019 540 Booklet, *Personal Income Tax Booklet* to figure the deduction amount.

Note: Taxslayer will calculate the allowable deduction for dependents. Make sure, "Can be claimed as a dependent" box is checked.

Exemption Credits

The 2019 personal exemption credit amount for single, married filing separate and head of household filers is $122 and for joint filers or surviving spouses is $244. The dependent exemption credit for tax year 2019 is $378.

Note: If your client's 65th birthday is on January 1 2020, they are considered to be age 65 on December 31 2019.

Head of Household

Head of Household Schedule 3532 must be filed with the tax return when filing Head of Household.

California Income

In general, California law often conforms to the Internal Revenue Code (IRC). However, California may not adopt all of the federal tax laws. For more information, go to irs.gov, ftb.ca.gov and FTB Publication 1001, *Supplemental Guidelines to California Adjustments.*

California taxes:

- Foreign earned income
- Interest income from non-California state and local bonds
- Interest income from District of Columbia bonds issued after December 27, 1973
- Interest income from municipal bonds issued by a county, city, town, or other local government unit in a state other than California
- Foreign social security income

California does not tax:

- Interest income from U.S. savings bonds, U.S. Treasury Bills, or any other bonds of the U.S. or U.S. Territories
- State income tax refunds
- Unemployment compensation and paid family medical leave in lieu of unemployment
- Social security benefits
- Tier 1 and tier 2 railroad retirement benefits
- California lottery winnings

Unemployment repayments- Repayments are not deductible as a California itemized deduction because the original payment was not taxed by California.

If the taxpayer has to pay back income reported in a prior year, the amount or the repayment may be allowed as a misc. itemized deduction equal to the amount repaid. This is known as a Claim of Right. If the amount repaid is more than $3,000, he/she may take a credit against their tax for the year of repayment. See the instructions for Claim or Right in to 540 or 540NR booklet.

Nonqualified HSA Distributions- Distributions from an HSA not used for qualified medical expenses and included in federal income are not taxable for California purposes. See the "Additions or Subtractions to Income" in the State return preparation section to input this Value. "Nonqualified HSA" can be used as the description for the adjustment.

For additional information, reference the 540 booklet.

Wages and Salaries – W2 income

Wages and salaries have a source where the services are performed. The location of the employer where the payment is issued, or your location when you receive payment does not affect the source of this income. Residents include all wages and salaries earned, regardless of where the services were performed. Nonresidents include the income for services performed in California.

In Home Support Services (IHSS)

IHSS payments referred to as Medicaid Waiver Payments, are excluded from gross income pursuant to IRC section 131(c).

This means wages received by an IHSS provider who lives with the person receiving their services are not considered "gross income" for federal purposes.

California conforms to IRC section 131(c) under Revenue and Taxation Code (R&TC) section 17131, so it follows IRS guidance. Therefore, IHSS payments made to an individual living with the person for whom he or she provides care for will be excludable income for California.

To help you identify IHSS payments, the W2 will show the address of the employer as PO Box 1717 Roseville, CA .

TaxSlayer software tip: IHSS payments will all have the same federal EIN number on the W-2. Once you enter the Federal EIN, the system may auto populate the federal information such as the employer name and address. The system populates the employer's name based on the last updated IHSS W2 entered. Be sure to update the employer's name to match the name shown on the W2.

The state ID will also auto populate based on the Federal EIN. Each employer has a unique state ID assigned to him or her. If the state ID auto populates, be sure to update the state ID to match the W2 in hand.

Starting in 2018, the care provider may receive a W2 from IHSS reporting zero wages in box 1 of the W2. If there is no dollar amounts reported other than in box 3-6 and no state tax withheld in box 17 of the W2, there is no need to enter the W2.

TaxSlayer software tip: TaxSlayer will not allow you to enter a W2 with zero dollars reported in box 1 unless code Q is entered in box 12 of the W2. (Code Q is for Combat Pay which is not relevant here).

If the care provider receives a W2 from IHSS reporting income in box 1 and they state that they lived for the entire year with the person they provide care for, an adjustment will need to be made on both the federal and state return to exclude the income from their gross income.

If the provider states they lived only for part of the year with the person they cared for and box 1 shows the same income in box 1, 3 and 5 of the W2, you will need to calculate the excludable portion of their income.

TaxSlayer software tip: When entering the W2 in TaxSlayer, under the W2 entry screen, there is a Medicaid Waiver Payment entry box located under box 13. In this box/field, you will need to enter the same amount from box 1 if the taxpayer lived with the person all year or the calculated excludable portion of income if the taxpayer lived with the person for part of the year.

Tax form tip: Enter on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 1 column B the IHSS supplementary payments included in federal wages.

CALEITC for Medicaid Waiver Payments (IHSS)

An additional adjustment will need to be made on the California return Form 3514 to remove the Medicaid Payments from the calculation of CALEITC.

TaxSlayer software tip: Under the State section in TaxSlayer under credits, you will need to open Form 3514, in the second to last entry box enter the amount of Medicaid Waiver Payments excluded from the W2.

IHSS Payments and CALEITC

If you have a taxpayer who has IHSS payments that are excludable from income tax, place the amount in the box 13 titled "Medical Waiver Payments in Box 1" of the W2. If this is the only income source for the taxpayer, the amount in box 1 of the W2 will not flow through to FTB 3514 and the taxpayer will not qualify for CALEITC.

Indian tribal Income

For tax year 2018 and after

Beginning January 1 2018, income of tribal members of a federally recognized California Indian tribe living in California Indian country earned from any federally recognized California Indian country is exempt from California taxation. The exemption applies to "earned income" which includes wages, salaries, commissions or professional fees and other amounts received as compensation for personal services actually rendered. This does not apply to "received income" (per capita income).

Wages earned are exempt from California tax if all of the following requirements are met:

- The taxpayer is an enrolled member of a federally recognized California Indian tribe
- The taxpayer lives in any tribes of California Indian country, which includes:
  - Reservations
  - Dependent Indian Communities
  - Indian trust allotments
- The taxpayer earned the IRS W-2 wages performing services within the boundaries of any California Indian reservation. This applies even when the payor is a public or private employer, such as a fast food chain or a federally funded hospital.

Per Capita Income

Enrolled tribal members who receive per capita income must still reside in their affiliated tribe's Indian country for the per capita income to be exempt from taxation.

Per capita income is exempt from California tax if all of the following requirements are met:

- The individual must be an enrolled member of a federally recognized California Indian tribe
- The individual must reside in the affiliated tribe's California Indian country
- The individual must receive reservation sourced income from the same California Indian country in which the individual lives and is an enrolled member

For tax year 2017 and prior, please refer to FTB Publication 1001

TaxSlayer software tip: In the State section of TaxSlayer under subtractions from income, select other subtractions. Then select Other Subtractions (1). Three entries need to be made on this page. 1) Enter the description of the subtraction. 2) the amount of the tribal income to be subtracted and 3) select "No" from the drop down menu (Is this entry Native American income, which may be reported on FTB 3504). Taxpayers need to file FTB 3504 separate from their tax return.

Tax form tip: Enter on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 1, column B the earnings and/or on line 21f, column B, any other income that is included in federal income that is exempt for California.

Interest income

Non-California bonds

1. United States - Federal law requires interest earned on federal bonds (U.S obligations) to be included in gross income. California does not conform. The following are not considered U.S obligations for California purposes: Fannie Mae, Ginnie Mae or Freddie Mac.

TaxSlayer software tip: In the federal section select Income (Income>Interest and Dividends>Interest or Dividend Income> Interest Income, Form 1099-INT). Interest income from U.S obligations that is entered in box 3 of the 1099-INT should also be entered in the box labeled "Amount of interest on U.S savings Bonds and Treasury Obligations that you want subtracted from your state return". Once you have entered the amount in this box, you will need to select California from the box labeled "Please select your state". This box will only appear after you have entered an amount that needs to be subtracted from your state return.

Tax form tip: Enter the amount of federal bond interest included in federal income on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 2, column B

2. Other States- California does tax the interest from non-California state and local bonds.

TaxSlayer software tip: Federal law does not tax interest from state or local bonds. California does tax this income. Go to the Federal section (Income>Interest and Dividends>Interest or Dividend Income> Interest Income, Form 1099-INT). If box 8 shows state and local bonds other than California, you will enter the tax-exempt portion for federal. Under the Taxable State Interest title, click on "Add interest items". Select California from the drop down and enter the amount of interest that should be taxed to California.

Tax form tip: Enter the interest from non-California state or local bonds on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 2, column C.

Exempt interest dividends (Mutual Funds)

California does not tax dividends paid by a fund attributable to interest received from U.S. obligations, California State, or municipal obligations **IF** at least 50% of the fund's assets would be exempt from California tax when held by an individual. California taxes dividends derived from mutual funds that are paid from interest received from obligations (bonds) issued

by non-California states or municipalities in other states. The fund will provide a statement regarding the dividends it pays.

Tax form tip: If the value of U.S. and California state or municipal obligations is at least 50% of the fund's total assets, enter the amount of exempt interest dividends that are attributed to U.S. obligations included in federal income on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 2, column B.

Dividend Income

Dividend income is any distribution of a company's earnings to shareholders from stocks or mutual funds you owned. Tax treatment of dividend income depends on whether the income meets the definition of a qualified dividend and if it is held in a retirement account, like an IRA.

A qualified dividend is a dividend that receives more favorable tax treatment by being taxed at capital gains rates. The dividend must have been paid by a U.S. company or a qualifying foreign company.

Money in any type of IRA account actually avoids taxes. You will not pay taxes on dividends that are reinvested in either a Roth IRA or a traditional IRA and left in the account.

Capital Gain or Loss

A capital gain is what the tax law calls the profit you receive when you sell a capital asset, which is property such as stocks, bonds, mutual funds shares and real estate. Capital loss is the reverse of capital gain. It results in a loss when the investment is sold. This does not include your primary residence. Special rules apply to these sales, which we will go over later in this section.

The law divides capital gains into two different classes (short-term gain and long-term gain) determined by the calendar. There is a big difference between short-term and long-term capital gains. Short-term gain comes from the sale of property owned one year or less; Long-term gains come from the sale of property held more than one year. Short-term gains are taxed at your maximum tax rate, as high as 37% in 2018. Most long-term gains are taxed at either 0%, 15% or 20% for 2018.

Capital gains and losses are reported on Form 1099-B, which is often part of a brokerage statement. Separate management fees or investment fees charged by the brokerage cannot be claimed on the federal Schedule A as of January 1, 2018. This deductible expense was subject to a 2%-of-AGI reduction that was eliminated. California does not conform; therefore, this expense is allowable as a California itemized deduction subject to 2%-of-AGI.

TaxSlayer software tip: Go to the Federal section select Income> Capital Gains and Losses-Schedule D> Capital Gains and Loss items. On the Capital Gains Transaction page, complete the needed information. For additional instructions on how to enter capital gains and losses in TaxSlayer see Publication 4012.

Tax form tip: On Schedule D (540) line 1, Column (a), enter the description of the property. Line 1, Column (b), enter gross sales price or net sales price. Line 1, Column (c), enter the cost or other bases. Line 2, enter the net gain or (loss). Line 3, enter the capital gain distribution. Line 6, enter any capital loss carryover from the prior year. Line7, total of lines 5 and 6. Line 8, enter your net gain or loss to carryover to the next year. Line 9, enter the smaller of the loss on line 8 or $3,000 ($1,500 if you are married/RDP filing separate return). Line 10, enter the gain or loss from federal Schedule 1, line 13. Line 11, enter the California gain from line 8 or (loss) from line 9. Line 12, (a) compare the amounts entered on line 10 and line 11 to figure the adjustment to enter on Schedule CA (540), Part I, line 13, column B. Line 12(b) compare the amounts on line 10 and 11 to figure the adjustment to enter on the Schedule CA (540), Part I, line 13, column C.

Gain on sale of personal residence

For sale or exchanges after May 6, 1997, federal law allows an exclusion of gain on the sale of a personal residence in the amount of $250,000 ($500,000 if married filing jointly). The taxpayer must have owned and occupied the residence as a principal residence for at least 2 of the 5 years before the sale. California conforms to this provision. However, California taxpayers who serve in the Peace Corps during the 5-year period ending on the date of the sale may reduce the 2-year

period by the period of service, not to exceed 18 months. If the home is sold by a widow/widower within 2 years of the date of death of their spouse, the widow/widower may potentially qualify for the $500,000 exclusion as well.

If there are California tax withheld from the sale, the sellers will receive California Form 593.

TaxSlayer software tip: Report the sale or exchange of your main home as a Capital Gain or Loss if you cannot exclude all of your gain from income, or you receive a Form 1099-S for the sale or exchange. Go to the Federal section select Income> Capital Gains and Losses-Schedule D> Sale of Main Home Worksheet. On the Sale of Home page, complete the needed information. For additional instructions on how to enter capital gains and losses of sale of main home in TaxSlayer, see Publication 4012. To enter any withholdings from Form 593 received, go to the State Section>payments>Ca Real Estate Withholdings (Form 593) and enter the information needed on that page and the five associated pages. All the information needed will be found on Form 593.

Tax form tip: If there is a difference between the amounts excluded (or depreciated, if recapture applies) for federal and California, complete California Schedule D (540 or 540NR). Transfer the amount from California Schedule D, line 12a, to Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 13, column B (if gain is less than federal). Transfer the amount from California Schedule D, line 12b, to Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 13, column C (if gain is more than federal)

Capital loss carrybacks

Federal law allows a deduction for carrybacks of certain capital losses. California has no similar provision.

Pensions, Annuity income, and IRA distributions

Taxpayers are required to take minimum distribution from their account each year at a certain age. Generally you have to start taking withdrawals from your IRA, SEP IRA, Simple IRA, or retirement plan account when you reach age 70 ½. Roth IRA's do not require withdrawals until after the death of the owner.

Pension and annuity income and IRA distribution income is reported on three different forms.

- Form RRB-1099-R is for Railroad Retirement Benefits
- Form CSA 1099- This form is a close variant of the standard Form 1099-R
- Form 1099-R this is the standard form.

Railroad retirement benefits

California does not tax railroad retirement benefits reported on federal Form RRB-1099-R, Annuities or Pensions by the Railroad Retirement Board, or RRB-1099, Payments by the Railroad Retirement Board.

Taxslayer software tip: Railroad Retirement Benefits (RRB) are reported on two forms and are entered in two entry screens. Social Security Equivalent Benefits, Form RRB 1099 Tier 1 (this is a blue form) are entered on the Social Security Benefits screen. Treat the benefits reported on this form just as if the information was reported on Form SSA-1099. To enter Form RRB-1099-R Tier 2 (this is a green form), go to Federal section>Income>Ira/Pension Distribution>RRB-1099 and complete the information needed. For additional instructions on how to enter capital gains and losses of sale of main home in TaxSlayer, see Publication 4012.

Tax form tip: Enter on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 4, column B, the amount on tier 1 (non-social security equivalent) or tier 2 railroad retirement benefits included in adjusted gross income on your federal return. See FTB Pub. 1005, for more information.

Schedule K

The United States tax code allows certain types of entities such as estate/trust, partnership, or S-corporation to use "pass-through" taxation. This means that the income tax liability is passed from the entity to the individual(s) who have beneficial interest in the entity.

Schedule K-1 is the form used to report the amount that are passed through from the entity earning the income to the individual(s). The Schedule K-1 is slightly different depending on whether the taxpayer receives it from an estate/trust, partnership, or S corporation.

Only the following types of income reported on Schedule K-1 is within the scope of VITA/TCE program.

- Interest income
- Dividend income
- Qualified Dividends income
- Net short-term capital gains and losses (schedule D)
- Net long-term capital gains and losses (schedule D)
- Tax-exempt interest income
- Royalty income (schedule E)

If K-1 includes any deductions, expenses, credits, or other items not listed above, the return is out of scope.

Schedule K-1 (Form 1041):

Trust and estates use Form 1041 to file their tax returns. Some trusts pays the income tax on their earnings and some passes it through to the beneficiaries in which cases, the beneficiaries receive a K-1 that shows the income that they need to report on their own tax returns.

TaxSlayer software tip: Enter the information from K-1 Form 1041 part I and part II in TaxSlayer under the Federal section, under income > other income > K1-Earnings>Schedule K-1 Form 1041.

The foreign tax amount in box 14 B of Form 1041 can be entered in the Federal section, under the deduction > credits Menu> foreign Tax Credit Form 1116.

Schedule K-1 (Form 1120S):

S corporations file their annual tax return on Form 1120S. S corporation provides schedule K-1 to report each shareholder's share of income, losses, deductions, and credits. The shareholders use the information on K-1 to report their share on their separate tax returns.

TaxSlayer software tip: Enter the information from K-1 Form 1120S part I and part II in TaxSlayer under the Federal section, under income > other income > K1-Earnings >Schedule K-1 Form 1120S.

There is no Box 14 on TaxSlayer K-1 screen. Therefore, the foreign tax amount in box 14 L and M of K-1 Form 1120S can be entered in the Federal section, under the Deductions> Credits Menu> Foreign Tax Credit Form 1116. Amounts in Box 14 A, B, C, and D do not need to be entered in TaxSlayer. Also, any amount in Box 16 C (nondeductible expenses) does not need to be entered in TaxSlayer.

Schedule K-1 (Form 1065):

Business partnerships file partnership's tax return and report each partner's share of income, losses, deductions, and credits on tax Form 1065. Partnerships provides each partner with the Schedule K-1 reporting tax items so they can report them on their own tax returns. For example, a business of 2 equal partners earning $200,000 should issue a K-1 of $100,000 income for each partner.

TaxSlayer software tip: Enter the information from K-1 Form 1065 part I and part II in TaxSlayer under the Federal section, under income > other income > K1-Earnings >Schedule K-1 Form 1065.

There is no Box 16 on TaxSlayer K-1 screen. Therefore, enter the foreign tax amount in box 16 L and M of K-1 Form 1065 in TaxSlayer in the Federal section, under the Deductions> Credits Menu > Foreign Tax Credit Form 1116. Amounts in Box 16 A, B, C, and D and box 18 C do not need to be entered in TaxSlayer.

Tax form tip: Follow the instructions for Schedule K-1 (100S, 541, 565 or 568). Some items are reported directly on Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), Part II, line 17 and some items must be reported on other forms and schedules.

Gambling W2-G

California lottery winnings (Powerball, MEGA Millions, SuperLotto Plus, etc) are not taxed by California. If there are California lottery winnings reported to federal, an adjustment has to be made to the California return. All other lottery winnings are taxed by California including winnings earned from the California Indian casinos.

A taxpayer can take gambling losses up to the amount of gambling winnings. California lottery losses are not deductible for California.

TaxSlayer software tip: To enter Form W-2G, go to Income>Other Income>gambling Winnings Form W2-G and complete the information needed. If the source of the W-2G is California lottery, a manual adjustment will need to be made by going to the State Section>subtractions from income, and select California lottery winnings. Enter the amount of California lottery winnings that were won.

Tax form tip: If the W2-G is California lottery winnings you will need to make an adjustment by going to Schedule CA (540), Part I or Schedule CA (540NR), line 21, column B.

Cancellation of Debt

If a debt is canceled, forgiven or discharged, you must include the canceled amount in your gross income and pay taxes on that income unless you qualify for an exclusion or exception. Creditors who forgive $600 or more of debt are required to file Form 1099-C with the IRS. California did not conform to the federal rules for mortgage forgiveness from 2014 through 2017 tax year.

Cancellation of debt for foreclosures, repossessions and abandonment has the potential to be insolvent, therefore consult your site coordinator regarding these types of cancellations. This type of debt is out of scope for VITA.

TaxSlayer software tip: To enter a 1099-C received by the taxpayer for credit card debt, go to Income>Other Income>Cancellation of Debt Form 1099-C and fill out the needed information. No adjustment needed for California.

Tax form tip: Cancellation of debt income is included in the total adjusted gross income that comes over to Form 540 or 540(NR) line 13 from federal Form 1040, line 7. No additional adjustment needed for California.

Kiddie Tax

For tax years 2013 and after, dependent children are required to pay taxes for California at their parent's tax rate on investment income that exceeds $2,200. This is Kiddie Tax, and is calculated on FTB 3800, *Tax Computation for Certain Children with Unearned Income*. The form should be included with their return.

Kiddie tax applies if:

- The child is either:
- Under age 18 at the end of the year
- Age 18 at the end of the year and did not have earned income that was more than half of the child's support
- A full-time student over age 18 and under age 24 at the end of the year, and did not have earned income that was more than half of the child's support
- Either one of the child's parents is living at the end of the year
- The child does not file a joint return for the tax year
- The child's investment income for 2018 is more than threshold amount

However, parents may elect to include their child's investment income on their California tax return using FTB 3803 if they meet all of the requirements. In this case the child is not required to file a return. For the requirement and additional information, go to FTB 3803 Instructions.

If the child is required to file a return, they can use FTB 3800 to compute the tax on investment income at the parent's tax rate.

Itemized vs Standard Deductions

Generally, California conforms to federal law regarding itemized deductions. However, with the Tax Cut and Jobs Act of 2017, there are some differences. For more information, go to FTB Publication 1001, *Supplemental Guidelines to California Adjustments*.

The standard deduction ensures that all taxpayers have at least some portion of their income that is not subject to federal and state tax. The standard deduction lowers your taxable income by a fixed amount.

For Federal, the 2019 standard deduction for single or Married Filing Separate taxpayers is $12,200. For Head of Household it is $18,350 and for Married Filing Joint or Qualifying Widow(er), it is $24,400.

For California, the 2019 standard deduction for Single or Married Filing Separate taxpayers is $4,537. For Joint, Surviving Spouse or Head of Household taxpayer's, the standard deduction is $9,074.

The itemized deduction allows taxpayers who qualify to deduct more from their adjusted gross income than they could by taking the standard deduction. Federal law governs which goods, services, contributions and other expenses qualify as an itemized deduction on the Schedule A. There are some differences between federal and state law in regards to which goods, services, contributions and other expenses can be deducted on the Schedule CA (540) for California.

If a married/RDP couple elects to file separately and itemize, they must itemize their deductions even though one spouse's amount might be less than the standard deduction. You must split itemized deductions based on the community property rules or separate property rules. Normally deductions follow the income funds used to pay the expense. You must attach the IRS Schedule A (Form 1040), Itemized Deductions or statement on a sheet of paper showing the division of the deductions to the California return.

Misc. Itemized Deductions

California does not conform to the suspension of all miscellaneous itemized deductions. All miscellaneous expenses subject to the 2 percent AGI limitation such as unreimbursed employee expenses, tax prep fees, safe deposit box fees and/or expenses to produce or collect income such as investment expenses and fees are allowable deductions on the state return.

Six California credits emphasized within the scope of VITA

They are:

- Earned Income Tax Credit
- Nonrefundable Renter's Credit
- Young Child Credit
- Child and Dependent Care Expense Credit
- Joint Custody Head of Household- Code 170
- Credit for Dependent Parent- Code 173
- Other State Tax Credit- Code 187

There are many other special credits, for a list of those credits go to, 2019 540 Booklet, *Personal Income Tax Booklet*.

California Earned Income Tax Credit (CalEITC)

California allowed earned income tax credit (EITC) beginning in the tax year 2015.

Working families making up to $30,000 may qualify for the earned income tax credit, regardless of whether the household has a qualifying child.

For 2019, the maximum investment income to qualify for CalEITC is $3,828.

For 2018, anyone age 18 or older at the end of the year is eligible to receive the CalEITC if all other qualifications are met. Every taxpayer who qualifies for CalEITC will need to fill out Form 3514 and submit with his or her tax return.

You qualify for CalEITC for the 2019 tax year if:

- You have earned income (wages, self-employment income, etc.) and adjusted gross income within certain limits
- You, your spouse, and any qualifying children each have a Social Security Number issued by the Social Security Administration that is valid for employment
- You do not use the "married/RDP filing separately" filing status
- You lived in California for more than half the tax year

Number of Qualifying Children	CA Maximum Income is Less Than	CAL EITC (Up to)
None	$30,000	$240
1	$30,000	$1,605
2	$30,000	$2,651
3 or more	$30,000	$2982

FTB may need to verify the income and/or losses used to claim CalEITC before FTB can issue any refund. FTB may reach out to a taxpayer **by letter** requesting additional information. The request will come on the **FTB 4502: Additional Documentation Required- Refund Pending.**

Renters Credit

California residents or part-year residents who paid rent for at least six months on their principal residence located in California and who meet certain income requirements may claim a nonrefundable renters credit against their tax. Renter's credit is available for single filers with adjusted gross income of $42,932 or less and joint filers (including Head of Household and Qualifying Widow(er) with adjusted gross income of $85,864 or less.

Some requirements for the credit are:

- The client was a California Resident in the tax year being filed
- Their California AGI does not exceed the cut off limits
- They paid rent for at least 6 months of the tax year for property in California that was their principal residence
- The property cannot be exempt from property taxes

For a full list of requirements go to ftb.ca.gov and search for renter's credit. If taxpayers meet the requirements, the credit is:

- $60 for single or Married/RDP Filing Separately
- $120 for Married/RDP Filing Jointly, Head of Household or Qualifying Widow(er)
- $60 if only one spouse is a resident of California

Part-Year residents:

For taxpayers with part year California residency, the Renter's Credit amount differs as indicated in the following chart.

Single or Married/RDP Filing Separately

6 months	7 months	8 months	9 months	10 months	11 months	12 months
$30	$35	$40	$45	$50	$55	$60

Married filing jointly, HOH or Qualifying Widow(er)

6 months	7 months	8 months	9 months	10 months	11 months	12 months
$60	$70	$80	$90	$100	$110	$120

Young Child Credit

For tax year beginning on or after January 1, 2019, California enacted the new Young Child Tax Credit. The maximum credit is $1,000 for a qualifying taxpayer who qualifies for CalEITC and has a qualifying child under six years old on the last day of the year. The credit amount phases out as AGI exceeds the threshold amount of $30,000.

Child and Dependent Care Expenses Credit

California allows a non-refundable credit for child and dependent care expenses. Taxpayers may be eligible to claim this credit if they paid someone to care for their child or other qualifying person so they (and their spouse/RDP, if married) can work or look for work. If you are a nonresident of California, their earned income must be from California sources. A qualifying person is one of the following:

- A dependent of the client who is under 13 years of age and for whom the client is entitled to a dependent exemption credit
- The spouse or any dependent of the client, if he or she is physically or mentally unable to care for him or herself and for whom the client was entitled to a dependent exemption credit without regard to the gross income limitation

  The credit is a nonrefundable and is applied against the California net tax liability.

Credit for Joint Custody Head of Household – Code 170

Taxpayer's claim this credit if they meet the following criteria

- Taxpayer was not married at the end of 2019 (or lived apart from spouse for all of 2019 and used the Married/RDP Filing Separately filing status)

- Taxpayer furnished more than one-half the household expenses for their home, which also served as the home of their child, stepchild or grandchild for at least 146 days but not more than 219 days
- If the child is married, the child must be taxpayer's dependent. In addition, the custody arrangement for the child must be part of the decree of dissolution or legal separation or if must be part of a written agreement between the parents that covers the period between the filing of the petition and issuance of the decree
- Taxpayer can claim **EITHER** the Joint Custody Head of Household credit **or** the Dependent Parent Credit but not both.
- Taxpayer cannot claim this credit if he/she claim Head of Household, Married/RDP Filing Jointly or the Qualifying Widow(er) filing status. Use the JCHH credit worksheet to compute the credit.

  The maximum credit for 2019 tax year is $484 or 30 percent of net tax, whichever is less.

Credit for Dependent Parent – Code 173

Taxpayer can claim this credit only if:

- The taxpayer was married at the end of 2019 and is filing married/RDP Filing Separately (cannot use Single, Head of Household, Qualifying Widow(er) or Married/RDP Filing Joint status).
- The taxpayer furnished over one-half the household expenses for their dependent mother's/father's home (whether or not it was the taxpayer's home).
- The spouse/RDP was not a member of the household during the last six months of the tax year. The taxpayer does not qualify as a Head of Household or Qualifying Widow(er).

Go to Head of Household (HOH), Head of Household Qualification Requirements.

Note: Use the same worksheet you used for the JCHH credit to calculate the Dependent Parent credit.

Other State Tax Credit (Schedule S) – Code 187

In some instances, a taxpayer will be taxed by both California and another state on the same income. To prevent the income from being taxed twice, either California or the other state will generally allow an "Other State Tax Credit" to offset the taxes paid to the other state. To qualify for this credit, they must meet the following requirements:

- Be a resident of California
- Have a tax liability on income sourced in another state
- Paid a net income tax to another state and California on the same income

Attach a copy of the other state's tax return to the California return.

Note: You will need to complete the other state's tax return before completing FTB Schedule S.

The credit is not allowed for taxes paid to:

- Any city, county or other local government
- The Federal government
- A Foreign government

However, the credit may be allowed for taxes paid to the U.S. possessions

- American Samoa
- Guam
- Puerto Rico
- The Virgin Islands

California Residents – Schedule S – Qualifying States and U.S. Possessions

Alabama	Louisiana	North Dakota
American Samoa	Maine	Ohio
Arkansas	Maryland	Oklahoma
Colorado	Massachusetts	Pennsylvania
Connecticut	Michigan	Puerto Rico
Delaware	Minnesota	Rhode Island
District of Columbia*	Mississippi	South Carolina
Georgia	Missouri	Tennessee
Hawaii	Montana	Utah
Idaho	Nebraska	Vermont
Illinois	New Hampshire	Virginia
Indiana	New Jersey	Virgin Islands
Iowa	New Mexico	West Virginia
Kansas	New York	Wisconsin
Kentucky	North Carolina	

California Nonresidents- Nonresident are allowed a credit for taxes paid to **Arizona, Guam, Indiana (allowed for taxable years beginning before January 1, 2017), Oregon or Virginia**.

Estimated Tax Payments

State income tax is due on income as it is earned. There are two methods of paying tax on income earned: Withholdings and estimated payments. Estimated tax payments are not required if one of the exceptions below are met:

- Taxpayer has a tax liability less than $500 ($250 for married/RDP filing separately).
- Taxpayer's prior year return was not a full 12 months and they did not have a tax liability.
- The amount of the taxpayer's withholding plus estimated tax payments, if paid timely, is at least 90 percent of current year's tax or 100 percent of the tax shown on their last year's return.

If the taxpayer is required to make estimated tax payments, listed below is the quarterly installment payment schedule:

First Quarter: Due April 15th	Second Quarter: Due June 15th	Third Quarter: Due Sept. 15th	Fourth Quarter: Due Jan. 15th
30 Percent of tax liability	40 Percent of tax liability	0 Percent of tax liability	30 Percent of tax liability

Use Tax

For tax years beginning on or after January 1, 2015, if a taxpayer includes use tax on their personal income tax return, any payments made and any credits allowed will be applied to the use tax liability first before applying the payments and credits towards the income tax, interest, and penalties.

Amended Return

If you discover an error on a previously filed return, you should file an amended return and pay any additional tax or fee due, including interest. Generally, if you file a federal amended return (1040X) you should file a California amended return (540X or Schedule X) within six months unless the changes do not affect your California return. You may file an amended return to claim a refund for taxable years not closed by the general statute of limitations.

Generally, the statute of limitations is the later of:

- Four years from the original due date of the return
- Four years from the date a timely return is filed
- One year from the date of overpayment

However, the general statute of limitations may be extended by service in a combat zone, a disaster area or an assignment outside the United States. If the statute is extended because of military service in a combat zone or outside of the United States, you should attach copies of any documents that show when you served in a combat zone or overseas.

For tax years beginning on or after January 1, 2017, the Schedule X has replaced the Form 540X, Amended Individual Income Tax Return. The 540X is still used for tax years 2016 and prior.

TaxSlayer software tip: Once you have determined an amended return needs to be filed, verify the return was done at your VITA/TCE site.

If original return was completed in TaxSlayer and the status is accepted - open the originally filed return (If the taxpayer has not provided you with a copy of the originally filed return, print one from TaxSlayer prior to making any changes) and make the necessary changes. After the changes have been made click on “20XX Amended Return” from the left navigation bar. From here, you will need to click on "Explain Changes” to enter the reason why you are filing the amended return.

If you click on “20XX Amended Return”, you should see the figures from the original return. Since the return was originally filed at your site, TaxSlayer should automatically fill in this information. If the figures are not filled in, enter the figures from the printed copy of the original return.

If original return was completed in TaxSlayer and the status is accepted –

- Open the originally filed return and print a copy for later use.
- Make the necessary changes.
- Click on “20XX Amended Return” from the left navigation bar. At this point, you should see the figures from the original return automatically filled in by Taxslayer. If not, enter the figures from the printed copy of the original return.
- Click on "Explain Changes” to enter the reason why you are filing the amended return.

If original return was completed outside of your site-

- Client to provide a copy of the originally filed return along with all tax documents
- Create the return in TaxSlayer the way it **should** have been filed originally (i.e. with the corrections).
- Click on “20XX Amended Return” from the left navigation bar.
- Click on “Original Federal Return Information.” Enter the figures necessary using the printout of the original return filed.
- Click “Continue” when done.

Once complete, click on "Explain Changes” to enter the reason you are filing the amended return.

Amend State Return-

- Click on “Amend State Return(s)” from the “Amended Tax Return” screen.
- Click on “Amend State”. (Be sure not to click on the edit button/pencil, as this does not amend the state return). From the “California Return” screen.
- Click begin “Amended Return” at the bottom of the screen.
- From the “Amended Return” screen, select “Yes” from the drop down.
- Click begin “Review and Complete Amended Return”.
- From the “Review and Complete Amended Return”, you will be asked to enter payment information or overpayment information from the original return. You will also need to complete the two additional sections “Reasons for Amending” and “Explanation of Changes”.
- Click “Save” until you return to the “California Return” screen.
- Click “Exit California Return” to complete the amended state return.

Misc. information

State Disability Insurance

State Disability Insurance (SDI) is an itemized deduction on the federal tax return, but you subtract it from the state itemized deduction amount on Schedule CA (540).

Employers report the CASDI amount in box 14 or box 19 on the Form W2.

TaxSlayer software tip: The SDI amount is entered in box 14 of the W2 screen in TaxSlayer by selecting the drop down menu next to the box 14 and selecting CASDI. The software will automatically transfers the SDI amount on federal Schedule A and State 540 Schedule CA as long as the amount is entered correctly on the W2 screen. Double-check the software for accuracy of SDI deduction on federal Schedule A.

Employer’s State ID Numbers

California requires the state ID box on Forms W2, W2-G and 1099-R to include the employer’s ID number. If any of these forms has a blank state ID, enter six 0’s in this field.

Injured Spouse

Under federal law, a spouse may seek relief in instances where a refund on a joint return is used to pay (offset) a debt of the other spouse. California does not have a similar provision.

For additional nonconformity items, go to FTB Publication 1001, *Supplemental Guidelines to California Adjustments.*

Deceased Taxpayer

If a tax return is required for a deceased taxpayer, file a final tax return for the individual who died during the tax year. If there is a surviving spouse, file a joint tax return with the surviving spouse/RDP as long as the spouse/RDP did not remarry during 2019. Write “surviving spouse/RDP” next to their signature on the tax return.

If there is no surviving spouse/RDP and the decedent is due a refund, complete federal IRS Form 1310, *Statement of Person Claiming Refund Due a Deceased Taxpayer*, and submit with the return.

Remember, FTB VITA Team is here to assist!

Connect With Us

Web:	Free-Tax Help
Phone:	800.522.5665 from 8:00 am to 4:00 pm. weekdays, except state holidays
	916.845.7052 from outside the United States
Email:	volunteercoordinator@ftb.ca.gov
TTY/TDD:	800.822.6268 for persons with hearing or speech impairments
Fax:	916.845.9004